

LIFE

after high school

Justin Diep
Copy Editor

Many post-graduate students will face challenges as soon as the cap and gown are taken off. Everyone's path is different. Some will choose to go to college. Accord-

ing to educationdata.org, a website that seeks to make data about the American education system more open and accessible, 67 percent of high school graduates enrolled in college. Others may find a job right out of high school. Some

will move out, sometimes that is out of state or just across town. No matter what people decide to do after high school, it'll still be financially confusing and even overwhelming at times but it does not have to be this way.

Understanding some basic concepts can go a long way. From learning where money goes and how to save it, to understanding how credit works can lay a solid foundation for life ahead.

WAYS TO SAVE MONEY WHEN MOVING OUT

Infographic by | Olouwatobi Noukpozounkou

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THE SMALL THINGS

- When moving into a new house, ask parents for furniture and housewares
- Have an emergency fund, like saving a percentage of a check each month.
- Download an app to help you manage money better
- Instead of getting name brand items, buy the off-brand versions like Walmart's Great Value or Target's Good & Gather.

2

SCHOOL RELATED WAYS

- Use student discounts
- For those going to college, think of renting the needed textbooks because it'll cost less.
- Instead of buying a bed and couch, get a sofa-bed instead which is a mix
- People can save up to 10% off car insurance if they enroll in a drivers education course
- Getting a membership at Sam's Club or Costco can save people money if they buy in bulk and gas is cheaper

Costs of moving out add up

Justin Diep
Copy Editor

The cost of moving out can often surprise teenagers. Whether it is moving out to a college dorm or simply just living on your own in an apartment or a house, the bills can seem to just add up out of nowhere.

The breakdown for the average cost of living was gathered from bestplaces.net, a data analytical website about people and places, Numbeo, a crowd-sourced database and U.S. News & World Report.

The breakdown for the cost of moving into a college dorm was gathered from the University of Nebraska at Omaha's estimated cost of attendance.



Monthly Cost of Moving Out to an Apartment

-Rent of a two bedroom apt. \$992
-Utility bill \$180
-Internet bill \$78
-Health cost \$132

-Groceries \$95
-Cost of ownership for a car \$1,130
Total Monthly Cost: \$2,607



Monthly Cost of Attending College

-Tuition & Fees \$957
-Housing & Meals \$1225
-Books & Supplies \$132

-Personal Expenses \$279
-Transportation \$159
Total Monthly Cost: \$2752



Alumna shares experience moving out of state for college

Sophie Bacon
Reporter

Graduating and moving out is something almost every teenager must go through. Alumna Ashley Roth, was able to participate in collegiate level gymnastics and function as a college student while living out of state away from the comforts of her home.

One of the reasons Roth decided to go to Winona State University instead of an in-state college was because Nebraska only has one college that provides a gymnastics program.

"My main reason for leaving was gymnastics," Roth said. "I was excited, I wanted to go out of state no matter what. Getting to do my favorite sport and leaving was just a plus. Winona was the closest to Omaha. I knew right away when I visited this is where I wanted to go."

Moving out can also come with emotional strains from missing home and getting used to a new environment but there are ways to help overcome them.

"Leaving my family was extremely hard, they're the people I've grown up with my entire life and now I'm supposed to live six hours away and not see them for months on end," Roth said. "But, with being on the gymnastics team, I had friends here waiting for me and they very quickly became my family. We do everything together. They really helped with the transition."

Another deciding factor for Roth to go out of state was the cost of tuition and other living expenses. She was able to get a scholarship that allowed her to pay in-state tuition and she applied for student loans.

"Tuition is pretty cheap there for a four-year university," Roth said. "I wanted to

minimize the cost as much as possible, with being D3 I can't get athletic scholarships."

Balancing course work, athletics and a social life is no easy task. For Roth, she writes out all of her homework and class work she wants to get done each day and the weekend prior to it so she can stay on task and on top of everything.

"It's all about having a schedule and self accountability," Roth said.

Whether moving in-state or out of state, it can be a big adjustment with figuring out the correct balance between activities, home life and academics.

"I recommend it to everyone [moving out of state]," Roth said. "It's nothing but new experiences and meeting new people. I feel as if it really allowed me to find what I'm interested and enjoy."



Photo Courtesy of Ashley Roth

Working on course work in her dorm at Winona State University, Alumna Ashley Roth writes down all her work on a planner in advance to help her balance her life between school, gymnastics and her social life.

Credit scores have lasting effects

Lia Becker
Reporter

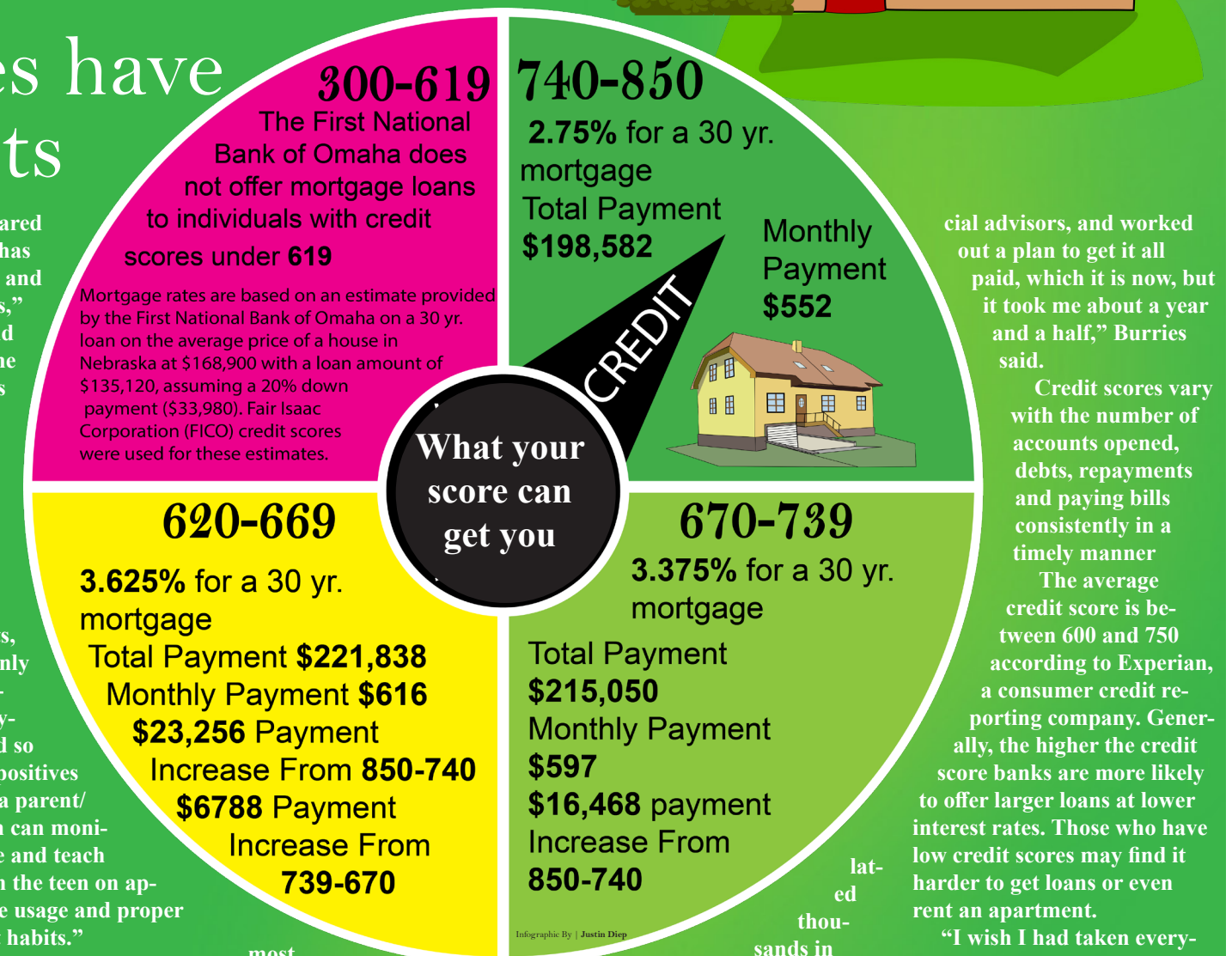
Credit is the ability to borrow money and then have to pay it back to the lender with interest. A credit score is a number calculated from the information in a person's credit reports, normally sourced by credit bureaus, to show the likelihood of paying their loans back on time. While credit may be scary and even confusing at times, business teacher Thomas Townsend offers some advice to those who may just be starting to build credit.

"People need to start thinking of credit as money they haven't earned yet," business teacher Thomas Townsend said.

To start building credit it is recommended to get a credit card. Banks require minors to share a joint account with a parent, both parties are responsible for payments and debts, but can be taken off the shared account later once a minor reaches the age of majority.

"A shared account has positives and negatives," Townsend said. "The negatives are the same as any card, over limit spending, late payments, paying only the minimum payment and so on. The positives are that a parent/guardian can monitor usage and teach and train the teen on appropriate usage and proper payment habits."

Whenever people use their credit cards, it should be for purchases which can be paid off as soon as possible. A minimum payment is required each month for credit cards, but



Infographic By | Justin Diep

most are advised to pay the entire bill monthly if they can so they can avoid interest. Alumna Teaira Burries accumulated thousands in credit card debt but was able to pay it off with the help of her bank. "I sat down with some people at the bank, like finan-

cial advisors, and worked out a plan to get it all paid, which is now, but it took me about a year and a half," Burries said.

Credit scores vary with the number of accounts opened, debts, repayments and paying bills consistently in a timely manner.

The average credit score is between 600 and 750 according to Experian, a consumer credit reporting company. Generally, the higher the credit score banks are more likely to offer larger loans at lower interest rates. Those who have low credit scores may find it harder to get loans or even rent an apartment.

"I wish I had taken everything I heard more seriously," Burries said, "If you don't take your credit seriously it will make things more difficult for the future."